



NEWSLETTER

TODAY'S HWARANGS, TOMORROW'S LEADERS

HIGHLIGHTS FROM NATIONAL DISTRICTS

Hwarang Recruitment Challenge: Next Generation Leadership Forum

Written by Alexis Lee

During the month of November, the Orange County District continued to build on the new initiative, the Hwarang Recruitment Challenge. This project was designed to encourage active participation from current members while introducing Hwarang to new students in an intentional and welcoming way. By utilizing the Next Generation Leadership Forum as a key opportunity for this effort, it allowed Hwarang members to invite friends who were interested in leadership, community, and personal growth. The forum provided a meaningful space for both members and guests

to meet and engage with Korean American leaders, who shared their journeys, impact, and growth as leaders. Friends had the opportunity to directly interact with these speakers through open discussions and conversations. Through this initiative, three guests attended alongside the Hwarang members, gaining views to the values and experiences that define Hwarang.



Hwarang members invite their friends to learn about the inspiring stories and insights of Korean American leaders at the Next Generation Leadership Forum



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SV District Commemorates 80 Years of Korean Independence and History of Dokdo

On October 25th and November 1st, members of the Hwarang Silicon Valley District gathered at the San Francisco & Bay Area Korea Center to commemorate the 80th anniversary of Korean independence. Guest speakers such as Park Gi-Tae from the VANK association, and Heo Seong-Ho, the chief producer of many historical documentaries on EBS such as “The Great Minds,” gave members an insightful speech regarding former political activists that helped influence Korean independence in the mid-20th century. In honor of the 80th anniversary of Korean independence, different chapters took part in preparing cultural showcases, like musical performances, dances, and art projects. Members presented their projects regarding Dokdo at the event, offering speeches that provided deeper insight into their work. Overall, Hwarang members gathered together to commemorate Dokdo and its history.



Learning to Lead in the Age of AI: SV District Hosts Nationwide AI Seminar

On November 11 2025, Silicon Valley District's IT Committee hosted the Fall AI Seminar, open to all Hwarang members. Members from SV District met at a library community room to hear the seminar in person and members from other parts of the US joined in through an online meeting. The guest speaker Mr. Sunghee Yun prepared a lecture with a slideshow using his experience working in various fields involving AI, including biotech and electrical engineering. The speaker highlighted the recently rapid trend in AI development and placed a spotlight on the different ways to take advantage of this opportunity as leaders, especially with the increasing prevalence of AI tools in the workspace. Hwarang members were able to engage in a Q&A session after the lecture concluded, asking compelling questions that Mr. Yun thoughtfully provided answers for. Overall, this was a successful event for all members worldwide.

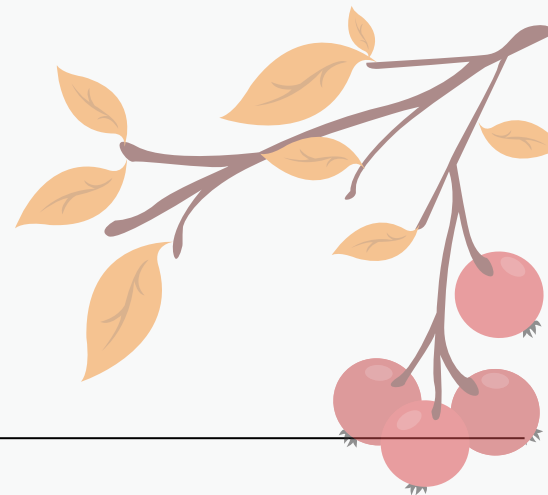


SV members pose for a picture with guest speaker Mr. Sunghee Yun after the Fall AI Seminar

Strengthening Connection and Collaboration at the LA District Meeting *Written by Terry Park*

For the months of October and November, one event that was especially meaningful was the Los Angeles District Meeting. This meeting served as a valuable opportunity for all Los Angeles chapters to come together in one space and strengthen their bond as a unified district. During the meeting, members reviewed past events, reflected on what went well, and discussed areas for improvement, which allowed everyone to

gain a clearer understanding of the district's progress. In addition, future events and important announcements were shared to ensure that all chapters were on the same page moving forward. A significant portion of the meeting was dedicated to an open discussion session, where many members had the opportunity to share their thoughts, ideas, and expectations for the district's future. This created an environment of transparency and mutual respect, encouraging members to feel heard and valued. The meeting also included conversations about future fundraising ideas, emphasizing collaboration and teamwork while finding ways to strengthen connections across chapters. Overall, the Los Angeles District Meeting helped build stronger relationships, foster new connections, and provide members with important updates that will guide the district's continued growth and success.



National Hwarang Leadership Hosts First National Meeting in the U.S.

Written by Audrey Lee

On Saturday, October 4th at 7 PM (PST), National Hwarang Leadership hosted the Hwarang Youth Foundation's very first National Meeting via Zoom, bringing together over 130 leaders and members from across the United States. The event was led by National Chair Yena Lee, with key support from National Secretary Audrey Lee, SV Chair Justin Kim, OC Chair Alexis Lee, LA Chair Terry Park, and Interstate Chair Solomon Kim. Leaders representing districts across Oregon, Idaho, Chicago, Seattle, Orange County (OC), Los Angeles (LA), and Silicon Valley (SV) shared updates on their local events and activities, allowing members to learn about the work and diverse activities happening across various communities.

Centered around the theme "Together We Rise, Together We Lead," the leaders and members engaged in meaningful discussions and formed new connections with fellow members across the nation. Members reflected on how while each district had unique activities that supported the needs and culture of their respective communities, their service and efforts still reflected Hwarang Youth Foundation's Five Loves and core values. Some members noted that the meeting and group discussions clarified their

vision of the foundation's future goals and direction as one unified team.



A leader from the Bethany Chapter in Oregon shares the activities the chapter has been involved in.



Medical Committee Chair Sonia Paik shares future committee projects the LA and OC Hwarang members will begin.

GREETINGS FROM OUR LEADERSHIP



Yena Lee

National Chairperson



Hello everyone. My name is Yena Lee, and it is a true honor to serve as the National Chairperson for this term. Currently, I am a junior at the Orange County School of the Arts, and I've always had a driven passion to give back to the community and uplift those around me. Aiding others has always brought me a sense of fulfillment—not just through acts of service, but in witnessing the pure joy and warmth those actions can bring to others. Seeing the smiles we help restore is what motivates me to keep going. One of my main goals this year is to be present. I firmly believe that presence is one of the most important qualities a leader can foster. While the past may shape us, dwelling on it can hold us back. However, by learning to let go and embracing the unpredictable paths ahead, we open ourselves to growth, clarity, and the ability to lead without constant worry. I'm excited for what this year holds, and I look forward to growing alongside our Hwarang Community.

Angela Lee

Summit Chairperson



Hello, my name is Angela Lee (11th grade) and it is with great enthusiasm that I introduce myself as the 2025-2026 Summit Chairperson of the Hwarang Youth Foundation. I am truly honored to take on this role, overseeing the LA and OC Districts, and to represent Hwarang in its multi-faceted yet united mission. Throughout this upcoming year, I hope our members can embody Hwarang's visions and to demonstrate the power of youth voices. I look forward to the continuance of our committed efforts and unwavering dedication that has held Hwarang as a stable pillar of our communities.

Terry Park

Los Angeles District Chairperson



Hello, my name is Terry Park. I am a rising junior at Downtown Magnets High School and I am serving as the LA District Chair for the 2025-2026 term of Hwarang Youth Foundation. My goals for this year is to support in making the LA District a healthy environment to comfortably live in while also sharing the story of Hwarang Youth Foundation.

Alexis Lee

Orange County District Chairperson



Hello! My name is Alexis Lee, and I am a sophomore at the Orange County School of the Arts. I am excited to serve as the Orange County District Chairperson for the 2025-2026 term. The OC District includes six chapters — Amerige, Eastland, San Diego, Shilla, Sunnyside, and Temecula — all of which consistently show dedication to their members and to our community. In this role, I am committed to supporting each chapter, encouraging collaboration, and helping create opportunities for connection and growth throughout the year. I am grateful to work alongside such motivated students, and I look forward to making this term even more meaningful and successful for everyone involved.



Justin Kim

Silicon Valley District Cabinet Chair

Hello, my name is Justin Kim, and I am a rising senior acting as one of the Silicon Valley District Cabinet Chairs. My goal for my term is to promote the creation of unique events.



Irene Yang

Silicon Valley District Cabinet Chair

Hello! My name is Irene Yang, a rising sophomore. I will be serving as part of the SV District Cabinet Chairs. For my term, my goal is to hold a variety of events and encourage members to explore and participate in various fields of interest.



Kaden Yoo

Silicon Valley District Cabinet Chair

Hi there, my name is Kaden Yoo. I am a rising junior. I will also be serving as a member of the SV District Cabinet Chair. My main goal is to recruit young leaders into the Hwarang family and help foster an encouraging and supportive volunteering environment for these future leaders to grow.



Solomon Kim

Interstate District Chairperson

Hi everyone! My name is Solomon Kim. I am a senior, and the Interstate District President for this term. This year being my third and final year in Hwarang, my goal is to be a sort of mentor figure to everyone in the district. Whether I receive big or small questions, I hope to pass down my own experiences of being a part of this organization to help guide the next cohort of members.

EDITOR'S NOTE



Hello Readers!

My name is Audrey Lee, and I am the National Secretary for the 2025-2026 Hwarang term! As the National Secretary, I am responsible for the publication of the bi-monthly National Newsletter, and I am so excited to share our newsletter issue with you! We currently have four Hwarang districts active in the United States with members located in various cities across the U.S.

Through meaningful stories and reflection we share, I hope our national districts can inspire one another and our community members to continue to serve others, learn about their cultural identity, and grow as leaders by witnessing the impact and service their fellow Hwarang members are sharing with their own communities across the nation.

Thank you for reading this issue, and we hope you will follow us in our journey this year.

Sincerely,
Audrey Lee

ABOUT HWARANG

"Hwarang," also known as Flowering Knights, refers to an elite group of male youth in Silla, an ancient kingdom of the Korean Peninsula. This group offered Silla a variety of education opportunities to create well-rounded elite members of the society. Inspired by that, Hwarang Youth Foundation is an organization for nurturing leadership and engagement. Composed of goal-driven future leaders, we aim to better the international community through consistent unified efforts. We seek to address issues within our communities by promoting the implementation of our active roles as advocates of love and peace. Each and every Hwarang individual is a diligent and passionate leader with high regard for community affairs. Coming together, we stand proudly as combatants against global issues. Hwarang has a saying, "Today's Hwarangs, Tomorrow's Leaders." Our Hwarang Youth Foundation and Save our Society are outlets to help students become effective, powerful, and active leaders of their respective communities.

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SOCIAL MEDIA



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